CSE0001: DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

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INTRODUCTION

This report documents my comprehensive journey as a Student Digital Ambassador during my first year of B.Tech (AI & ML). The goal of this
project was to develop a professional online presence, master digital communication, and promote cybersecurity awareness. Through five structured tasks, I have transitioned from a regular internet user to a responsible digital citizen equipped with the tools needed for a career in technology.

By establishing verified profiles on platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle, I have created a digital footprint that will track my academic and technical progress over the next four years. Furthermore, this project allowed me to explore critical areas such as cybersecurity, where I researched prevalent threats like phishing and UPI fraud.

TASK-1

For this task, I used Canva to create a infographic for my classmates. I choose Canva because it is a free and easy tool that has many helpful pictures and icons. I wanted the design to look professional and attractive but also easy to read on a phone or a laptop, so I used a blue and white colour theme. The design shows three important sections:

Section 1: This section explains that digital literacy means being smart online. It teaches you to check sources, tell facts and work well with others. It is about using the internet in a safe and honest way.

Section 2: This section suggests helpful apps for students. It recommends Google Scholar for research, Notion for organizing tasks, Goodnotes for digital notes, and Quizlet for studying with flashcards. These tools help you work faster and stay focused during your studies.

Section 3: This section shows how to write professional emails to professors. You must use a clear subject line, a polite greeting and a short, respectful message. Always finish with a formal signo K and your contact details to look professional
The most interesting part of making this was learning how to turn long, difficult ideas into small points. It was a bit hard to fit all the information on one page without it looking crowded, so I had to choose only the most important words. This project helped me understand that being ‘digitally literate’ is a skill we all need to succeed in our studies and future jobs.

TASK-2

For this task, I set up profiles on GitHub, Kaggle, and LinkedIn.

GitHub is a place where I can store my coding projects and show my work to the world.

Kaggle is a famous platform for data science and AI competitions, which will help me practice my machine learning skills.

LinkedIn is a professional social network that helps me connect with experts, professors, and future employers.

Over the next four years, I have a clear plan for these tools. I will use GitHub to build a portfolio of my class projects and AI hackathons.
On Kaggle, I plan to participate in beginner competitions to learn how to handle real-world data.

Finally, I will use LinkedIn to share my progress as a Student Digital Ambassador and stay updated on the latest trends in the tech industry. By using these platforms regularly, I hope to build a strong professional identity before I graduate in 2029.

TASK-3

I chose HackerRank as my primary platform for coding. I successfully completed the beginner-level challenges in Python and earned my Bronze Badge. This practice helped me understand basic Python logic.

Additionally, I used Google Forms to build a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. I created a Google Form with five specific questions to test how well my batchmates understand online safety, professional email etiquette, and technical tools. I also linked this form to a Google Sheet so I can easily track and analyse the responses.

These tools will be very helpful for my academic success over the next four years. HackerRank will help me prepare for technical interviews and improve my problem-solving skills for my B.Tech courses. Meanwhile, Google Forms and Sheets are essential for my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, allowing me to collect data and share helpful resources with my batchmates effectively.

TASK-4

One common situation where poor digital communication causes problems is when a student sends an urgent email to a professor without a clear subject line. For example, a student might name their email Help or leave the subject blank. Because professors receive hundreds of emails, they might miss this message or think it is spam. This can lead to a serious problem: the student might miss a deadline, lose marks, or fail an assignment simply because their request was never seen.

To prevent this, the student should have used a professional subject line, like Question about Assignment 1 - Student Name. They should also start with a polite greeting and explain their problem clearly. This helps the professor identify the issue quickly. Using a clear subject line and a polite greeting ensures that the message is taken seriously and answered properly.

TASK-5

While researching the topic of UPI Fraud and Phishing I was most surprised by how clever and real these scams look. I didn't realize that many scammers don't just hack into a system; they use Social Engineering to trick people into giving away their own Pins or passwords. This is when a criminal pretends to be someone you trust, like a bank officer or a helpful customer service agent. It was shocking to see how many students lose their hard earned money just by clicking a fake link or sharing a UPI pin. It surprised me to learn that even students who are good with technology can be fooled nowadays easily.

As a result of this research, the one habit I will personally change is how I handle Unknown Links. From now on, I will never click on a link in an SMS or email to make a payment. Instead, I will open the official app or website manually to check my account. I have also started using Two-Factor Authentication on all my main accounts to add an extra layer of safety.